

H+W Engineering — Teaming Partner Dossier

Prepared for Jim DesRoches, KOR Structural · SD trip 29 Jun – 1 Jul 2026 · Internal — not for distribution

Snapshot

H+W Engineering is the leading mid-market MEP (Mechanical / Electrical / Plumbing) consultancy in San Diego, covering the exact typologies — concrete multifamily high-rise, mixed-use, life-science, and commercial TI — that KOR targets in the SD metro. A KOR + H+W pairing closes the one gap every architect and developer experiences when assembling a project team: a structural engineer and an MEP firm that already trust each other and can deliver a seamless S + M + E + P front end. H+W is private, principal-led, and growing (two founders from SDSU who have built from zero to 50+ in 15 years); this is a firm that makes relationship-based teaming decisions, not procurement-committee ones. The right conversation with Tom Harmon or Bryan Wayne — framed as a peer principal-to-principal call — can produce a preferred-teaming arrangement that neither firm has to re-negotiate project by project.

Type	MEP consulting firm (Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing)
HQ	1810 Gillespie Way, Suite 207, El Cajon CA 92020 (San Diego metro)
Staff	~50 engineers, designers, and technicians
Founded	2009 as Harmon & Associates; rebranded H+W Engineering, Inc. 2017
Ownership	Private — principal-led (Harmon + Wayne)
Disciplines	Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing; BIM coordination; Architectural lighting; Energy / sustainability; Technology systems; Fire protection
KOR fit	Complementary (MEP + Structural = full S+M+E+P team); same developer/architect client book; same SD metro focus
Main line	619-659-8234 · hwengr.com

What They Do and Where

H+W provides full MEP engineering — mechanical (HVAC, process piping, plumbing systems), electrical (power distribution, lighting, power protection, technology systems), and plumbing design — on projects ranging from ground-up concrete residential towers to complex laboratory and life-science tenant improvements. They supplement core MEP with BIM / Revit coordination, architectural lighting design, energy modeling, sustainability consulting (LEED documentation), and technology systems (low-voltage, AV, security). This breadth is materially valuable in a teaming pitch: a developer writing an RFP can list one MEP entity and get every engineering discipline below structural covered.

Sectors (confirmed from their website): Housing and mixed-use (their volume lane), Office and commercial TI, Science and Technology / Life-science, Healthcare and Wellness, Education (including UCSD portfolio), Industrial, Military and Government, Hospitality and Retail, Civic, Central Plant.

Geography: Primary market is the San Diego metro; secondary markets include California statewide, and they hold active licenses in Arizona, Texas, Nevada, and Colorado — meaning a teaming relationship with KOR extends beyond SD wherever KOR pursues in the US Southwest.

Industry associations: ASHRAE San Diego, IES San Diego Section, ISPE (life-science), I2SL. Tom Harmon and Bryan Wayne met at San Diego State University and started their careers together at the same SD engineering firm before founding H+A in 2009.

Portfolio and Current Work

Named projects (H+W confirmed as MEP engineer unless noted):

Project	Location	Type / Scale	Developer	Architect	Structural Engineer	Status
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Project	Location	Type / Scale	Developer	Architect	Structural Engineer	Status
The Broderick	Bankers Hill, SD	17-story, 260 units, ~5,600 SF retail	CAST Development	Works Progress Architecture (Portland/LA)	Not publicly listed	Topped out Mar 2026; completion late 2026
Parco	National City, SD	8-story, 127-unit mixed-use, 130,000 SF	Malick Infill / Protea Properties	The Miller Hull Partnership	DCI Engineers	Completed 2021
The Minn	Golden Hill, SD	91-unit residential	Not published	Not published	Not published	In construction (earthwork complete; going vertical 2025/26)
UCSD Portfolio	La Jolla, SD	30+ lab renovations, solar, TIs, lighting	UC San Diego	N/A (campus facilities)	N/A	Ongoing; multi-year institutional client
Hologic Innovation Center	San Diego	Lab / office	Hologic Inc.	Not published	Not published	Complete; IIDA Southern CA Calibre Design Award nomination
CenterPark Amenities Building	San Diego	Commercial amenity	Not published	Not published	Not published	Complete; IIDA nomination
BDWY Lofts	San Diego	Residential	Not published	Not published	Not published	Listed in portfolio
Cleo Linda Vista	Linda Vista, SD	Residential	Not published	Not published	Not published	Listed in portfolio
Genesis Science Center	San Diego	Science / education	Not published	Not published	Not published	Listed in portfolio
Teri Campus of Life	San Diego	Healthcare / residential	Not published	Not published	Not published	Listed in portfolio
North Commons Student Housing	San Diego	Student housing	Not published	Not published	Not published	Listed in portfolio

Key finding on Parco/DCI: The one confirmed structural engineer on an H+W project found in public sources is **DCI Engineers** (San Diego office, 20 staff, Principal Ryan Slaybaugh, 101 W Broadway). DCI is KOR's primary displacement target in the H+W teaming relationship. DCI is a Seattle-headquartered firm with a satellite SD presence; KOR has deeper SD roots on concrete high-rise (Simone Little Italy — 36-story, 2024 ACI Best Residential Structure; The Grande twin towers, 40-story, ACI Multi-Family Residential Award).

Note: The structural engineer on The Broderick is not listed publicly on CAST Development's website, the Hoodline topping-out article, or BuildSD.org. This may be a firm not currently known to KOR — worth a casual ask of the H+W principals as a conversational opener ("Who did you have on structural for Broderick?").

Who to Know

Approach in this order: Mandy (routing) → Harmon + Wayne (principals meeting) → Wayne family secondary.

Name	Title	Email	LinkedIn
Mandy Serrano	Marketing Director	mandy@hwengr.com	/in/amandaserrano
Bryan Wayne, PE, LEED AP	Principal — Electrical (co-founder)	bryan@hwengr.com	/in/bryan-wayne-p-e-leed-a-p-a99a965
Tom Harmon, PE	Principal — Mechanical (co-founder)	<i>request from Mandy</i>	/in/tom-harmon-p-e-54110936
Austin Wayne	Director of Electrical Engineering	austin@hwengr.com	—

Name	Title	Email	LinkedIn
Eric Trafton	Plumbing Director	eric@hwengr.com	—
Travis Wagner, PE	Mechanical Director	(not yet verified)	—

Entry strategy: Mandy Serrano is the gatekeeper and the right first touch. She manages all business development and routes external teaming inquiries to the principals. She is active on LinkedIn, was recognized as one of CREW San Diego’s “50 Influential Leaders” (published September 2025 in the Daily Transcript), and is involved in ULI San Diego-Tijuana Young Leaders. An initial LinkedIn connection referencing a shared Miller Hull or UCSD pursuit is a natural icebreaker. Once she books the principals meeting, the conversation should be with Tom Harmon and Bryan Wayne together — they are co-equals and co-decide.

The Teaming Case

Why KOR + H+W is a complete team. Most architects and developers in the SD mid-market to institutional range must assemble structural and MEP separately, managing two separate negotiation tracks, two coordination interfaces, and two schedules. A standing KOR + H+W preferred-teaming arrangement eliminates that friction. Together the team covers: structural (KOR), mechanical, electrical, plumbing, BIM coordination, lighting, energy, and technology systems (H+W). That is every hard-engineering discipline on a project — exactly the package a Carrier Johnson, Ware Malcomb, or Miller Hull wants to propose to a Kilroy or HG Fenton.

Joint-pursuit angles (in priority order):

1. **Miller Hull joint pitch.** Both firms share Miller Hull as an architect relationship (H+W did MEP on Parco; KOR has SD presence). Miller Hull is active with mid-rise mixed-use in SD and National City. A warm intro from H+W’s principals to Miller Hull’s SD project managers — framed as “we work with KOR on structural now” — gets KOR in front of Miller Hull without a cold call.
2. **HG Fenton warm-path intro.** HG Fenton (private SD developer, 80+ years, ~7M SF of commercial and residential in SD) is listed directly on H+W’s client roster. KOR has no confirmed HG Fenton history. An H+W introduction to the HG Fenton construction/development team is a concrete deliverable Jim can request in the first meeting — it is not a favor, it is a mutually beneficial teaming relationship that gives H+W a structural partner on HG Fenton projects too.
3. **Preferred-teaming agreement.** Once principals have met, propose a one-page preferred-teaming MOU: H+W’s standard pursuit process adds KOR as structural; KOR’s standard SD proposal process recommends H+W as MEP. No exclusivity required — just first-call status. Both firms win more complete-team RFP responses; neither loses a pursuit they would have won alone.
4. **UCSD / Irvine Company TI pipeline.** H+W has a deep UCSD relationship (30+ active and recent projects). UCSD and similar institutional clients increasingly require a full engineering team on-call. A standing structural + MEP pairing positions both firms for IDIQ-style on-call contracts at UCSD, SDSU, or with Irvine Company Office Properties (shared client).

Risk — existing SE partner (DCI Engineers): The one confirmed structural engineer on a named H+W project is DCI Engineers (Parco, 2021, with Miller Hull). DCI is an established Seattle-based firm with a 20-person SD office led by Principal Ryan Slaybaugh. They are KOR’s direct displacement target. KOR’s pitch should not attack DCI by name — instead, position on project-specific advantages: KOR’s SD award-winning concrete high-rise track record (Simone, The Grande), KOR’s Vancouver + SD dual-market capability for developers like Pinnacle operating in both markets, and principal-to-principal senior involvement on every project (a stated H+W value).

Risk — H+W’s geographic focus vs. KOR’s US footprint: H+W is primarily San Diego-centric. If KOR pursues LA or other California markets, H+W may not be the natural MEP partner there; however, H+W does hold active licenses statewide and in AZ/TX/NV/CO, so the relationship has runway.

How Jim Opens the Conversation

Jim will be in San Diego June 29 – July 1. The play is a principals meeting with Tom Harmon and Bryan Wayne, booked via Mandy. Three to four talking points:

1. **Lead with Parco / Miller Hull.** “We’ve looked at your portfolio and the Parco project with Miller Hull stands out — 130,000 SF, 127 units, mixed-use. That’s exactly the typology we do on structural in this market. Who was your structural engineer on that one?” (This is a genuine question — opens the DCI displacement conversation without Jim having to raise it directly, and signals KOR has done its homework.)
2. **Name-drop the shared client book.** “We’ve been active on Kilroy Realty and Irvine Company TIs on the structural side. Sounds like you’re in the same rooms. We should be walking into those pursuits together.” This frames the relationship as reciprocally valuable from the first minute.
3. **Propose the preferred-teaming ask concretely.** “What we’re interested in is a first-call arrangement — when you’re putting together an MEP team for a structural pursuit, KOR is your structural; when we’re putting together a team for a developer, H+W

is our MEP. We don't need a formal contract. We just want to be in each other's proposals." This is a low-friction ask and consistent with how smaller firms in the SD market operate.

4. **Ask the HG Fenton warm-intro question directly.** "You've done work with HG Fenton. We don't have a direct relationship there yet. If you've got a project manager or VP of construction you work with, an introduction as your structural partner would go a long way." This is the highest-value near-term deliverable from the meeting.
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Sources

- H+W Engineering company website: <https://hwengr.com/>
- H+W About page: <https://hwengr.com/about/>
- H+W Team page: <https://hwengr.com/team/>
- H+W Markets page: <https://hwengr.com/markets/>
- H+W Housing & Mixed-Use portfolio: <https://hwengr.com/project/housing-mixed-use/>
- H+W UCSD portfolio: <https://hwengr.com/gallery/ucsd/>
- Mandy Serrano — CREW San Diego "50 Influential Leaders": <https://www.crewsandiego.org/news-blog/50-influential-leaders-in-san-diego-mandy-serrano>
- Mandy Serrano — LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/amandaserrano/>
- Bryan Wayne — LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/bryan-wayne-p-e-leed-a-p-a99a965/>
- Tom Harmon — LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/tom-harmon-p-e-54110936/>
- H+W Engineering — LinkedIn company page: <https://www.linkedin.com/company/hwengineering>
- Parco / Miller Hull project page (structural = DCI Engineers): <https://millerhull.com/project/parco/>
- Miller Hull — Parco topping-out article: <https://millerhull.com/2021/standout-project-tops-out-at-8th-b-in-national-city/>
- The Broderick — CAST Development project page: <https://www.cast-dev.com/broderick>
- The Broderick — Hoodline topping-out (March 2026): <https://hoodline.com/2026/03/bankers-hill-high-rise-tops-out-as-260-new-homes-rise-by-balboa-park/>
- DCI Engineers San Diego office: <https://www.dci-engineers.com/locations/san-diego-california>
- KOR Structural — Simone Little Italy ACI award: <https://www.korstructural.com/2024/09/simone-little-italy-wins-aci-san-diego-chapter-award-for-best-residential-structure-2024/>
- KOR Structural — SD projects: <https://www.korstructural.com/projects/>
- H+W Engineering — Design Master software case study (2023): <https://www.designmaster.biz/customer-stories/2023/h-w-engineering.html>
- Jim DesRoches — LinkedIn (prior role: Glotman Simpson VP Operations US): <https://ca.linkedin.com/in/jim-desroches-4071507>
- ZoomInfo — H+W Engineering company profile: <https://www.zoominfo.com/c/hw-engineering-inc/450981655>